

Sunniva Jessop

Character Dossier

Fiercely protective of newcomers glassblower of the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon

Overview

Sunniva Jessop is a glassblower living in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon. Sunniva is 54 years old, originally from the Ninth Terrace, and is known around the Reading Well as fiercely protective of newcomers. In conversation Sunniva compliments people before disagreeing with them.

Background

Sunniva arrived in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon 19 years ago after leaving the Ninth Terrace under circumstances Sunniva describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Order of Wet Pages; the second was the one that stuck. Today Sunniva works as a glassblower near the Stacks of Ash and is paid, when paid at all, in ink-weights.

Sunniva learned the trade from Kenji Marchetti, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Sunniva's life is with Cassius Nightingale, over a matter neither will explain. The person Sunniva trusts most is Kwame Grimsby.

Current goal: to retire somewhere warm with Umbra. Greatest fear: a knock at the door after dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: fiercely protective of newcomers.

Speech pattern: Sunniva compliments people before disagreeing with them.

Tells: when lying, Sunniva mentions Umbra the raven for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Sunniva Jessop
Role	glassblower
Home	the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon
Hometown	the Ninth Terrace
Age	54
Favourite dish	grandmother's apple and onion hash
Pet	Umbra, a raven
Lucky number	566

<i>Workshop password</i>	saffron-fern
<i>Mentor</i>	Kenji Marchetti
<i>Rival</i>	Cassius Nightingale
<i>Closest friend</i>	Kwame Grimsby

Secret

Sunniva writes poetry under the pen name 'The Saffron' and has a small, devoted readership.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Sunniva: I am the glassblower. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Sunniva: Grandmother's apple and onion hash. Do not tell Cassius I said so.

Visitor: Is Umbra yours?

Sunniva: Umbra belongs to nobody. Umbra tolerates me. Lucky number is 566, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, autumn of year 25

Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 17 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. At the sluice gates, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. Sunniva repaired the oilskin map at the sluice gates for Rosalind, who paid in 85 ink-weights and a long story about the tax on doors. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the census. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Sunniva repaired the wax seal at the sluice gates for Mara, who paid in 46 ink-weights and a long story about the census.

Entry 2, spring of year 25

Sunniva found a bolt of linen half-buried near the Stacks of Ash and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the missing shipment. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Farida came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 3, spring of year 25

Percival came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the old tunnels reached the cataloguers' gallery. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 4, spring of year 25

Sunniva repaired the brass lantern at the sluice gates for Freya, who paid in 17 ink-weights and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the sluice gates. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Sunniva closed early, walked to the Stacks of Ash, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance.

Entry 5, summer of year 25

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Sunniva won 25 ink-weights from Cassius on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on grandmother's apple and onion hash. Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the sluice gates, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 6, autumn of year 25

Jorah came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Sunniva moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about the comet. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 51 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short.

Entry 7, autumn of year 25

Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. Sunniva repaired the pair of spectacles at the Stacks of Ash for Nikolai, who paid in 69 ink-weights and a long story about the quarantine. Sunniva repaired the glass float at the Stacks of Ash for Hyacinth, who paid in 50 ink-weights and a long story about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 8, spring of year 25

Sunniva repaired the copper pipe at the cataloguers' gallery for Kestrel, who paid in 69 ink-weights and a long story about the price of lamp oil. Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. Sunniva was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the cataloguers' gallery to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 9, autumn of year 25

A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Sunniva was hired to carry a signal flag from the sluice gates to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Sunniva repaired the copper pipe at the sluice gates for Tiberius, who paid in 12 ink-weights and a long story about the quarantine.

Entry 10, winter of year 25

Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the Reading Well. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Sunniva was hired to carry a signal flag from the Reading Well to the Archivist's cell without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Sunniva repaired the spool of wire at the Reading Well for Delphine, who paid in 82 ink-weights and a long story about the rumour of a second well. At the Reading Well, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 11, autumn of year 25

Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 75 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. At the Stacks of Ash, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 12, summer of year 25

At the cataloguers' gallery, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the cataloguers' gallery: 11 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva

suspects Kwame and is probably right. Sunniva found a brass lantern half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Sunniva found a hand bell half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 13, winter of year 26

Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. Sunniva was hired to carry a hand bell from the sluice gates to the Reading Well without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Teodora came by asking about the singing at the docks. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the comet. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 14, spring of year 26

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Sunniva repaired the hand bell at the sluice gates for Yevgenia, who paid in 55 ink-weights and a long story about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 15, spring of year 26

Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. Sunniva found a grain scale half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Sunniva found a sextant half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the cataloguers' gallery. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 16, autumn of year 26

Sunniva closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. Sunniva was hired to carry a signal flag from the Reading Well to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the harvest count. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 17, winter of year 27

Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. Sunniva won 64 ink-weights from Cassius on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on grandmother's apple and onion hash.

Entry 18, winter of year 27

Sunniva repaired the iron kettle at the sluice gates for Ignatius, who paid in 47 ink-weights and a long story about the old tunnels. Sunniva won 54 ink-weights from Cassius on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on grandmother's apple and onion hash. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of

them conceding. Sunniva was hired to carry a oilskin map from the sluice gates to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Sunniva repaired the iron kettle at the sluice gates for Ravi, who paid in 85 ink-weights and a long story about the price of lamp oil.

Entry 19, autumn of year 27

Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. Sunniva found a bundle of letters half-buried near the Archivist's cell and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Sunniva found a tin whistle half-buried near the Archivist's cell and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 20, summer of year 27

A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Sunniva was hired to carry a spool of wire from the Reading Well to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. The weather turned. Sunniva moved the wax seal indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about the tariff on salt.

Entry 21, autumn of year 28

Sunniva won 51 ink-weights from Cassius on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on grandmother's apple and onion hash. The weather turned. Sunniva moved the ledger indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about who really won the regatta. At the cataloguers' gallery, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 22, winter of year 28

Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. The weather turned. Sunniva moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about the comet. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the cataloguers' gallery: 39 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. At the cataloguers' gallery, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 23, summer of year 28

Rumours about the tax on doors reached the Archivist's cell. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Sunniva closed early, walked to the cataloguers' gallery, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 24, autumn of year 28

Someone left a bolt of linen on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. The weather turned. Sunniva moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about the price of lamp oil. Brigid came by asking about the singing at the docks. Sunniva said

nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. At the Reading Well, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 25, winter of year 29

Hollis came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. Greta came by asking about the harvest count. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. Sunniva was hired to carry a hand bell from the cataloguers' gallery to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 26, summer of year 29

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Sunniva was hired to carry a spool of wire from the Archivist's cell to the Reading Well without opening it, and mostly succeeded. The weather turned. Sunniva moved the pair of spectacles indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about the harvest count. Sunniva closed early, walked to the Reading Well, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance.

Entry 27, summer of year 29

Rumours about the quarantine reached the Stacks of Ash. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the Stacks of Ash, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. Sunniva closed early, walked to the cataloguers' gallery, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance.

Entry 28, autumn of year 29

Sunniva found a copper pipe half-buried near the Reading Well and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Phaedra came by asking about the census. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 29, summer of year 30

Sunniva was hired to carry a spool of wire from the Reading Well to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 30, summer of year 30

Sunniva repaired the sack of salt at the Reading Well for Viggo, who paid in 78 ink-weights and a long story about who really won the regatta. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the census reached

the Reading Well. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 31, spring of year 30

Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the Archivist's cell: 43 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short. Sunniva found a sextant half-buried near the Archivist's cell and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Sunniva repaired the oilskin map at the Archivist's cell for Yannick, who paid in 78 ink-weights and a long story about the quarantine.

Entry 32, summer of year 30

A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Sunniva won 7 ink-weights from Cassius on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on grandmother's apple and onion hash. Sunniva repaired the tin whistle at the Reading Well for Freya, who paid in 44 ink-weights and a long story about the census.

Entry 33, spring of year 30

A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Imogen came by asking about the missing shipment. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the Reading Well; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the Reading Well: 39 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short.

Entry 34, winter of year 30

Rumours about the census reached the sluice gates. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 53 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short. Kenji came by asking about who really won the regatta. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 35, summer of year 30

Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the Stacks of Ash. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Sunniva moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about the quarantine. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the Stacks of Ash; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 36, summer of year 30

Sunniva found a cracked compass half-buried near the Reading Well and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the Reading Well, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. Sunniva repaired the grain scale at the Reading Well for Corvina, who paid in 60 ink-weights and a long story about the missing shipment.

Entry 37, winter of year 30

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the new curfew. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the new curfew reached the Stacks of Ash. Sunniva

pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Sunniva closed early, walked to the Archivist's cell, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the Stacks of Ash; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 38, summer of year 30

Sunniva was hired to carry a spool of wire from the cataloguers' gallery to the Reading Well without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right. Sunniva won 75 ink-weights from Cassius on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on grandmother's apple and onion hash. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Sunniva moved the sextant indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about the comet.

Entry 39, summer of year 30

Sunniva was hired to carry a glass float from the cataloguers' gallery to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the cataloguers' gallery, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone. Sunniva was hired to carry a wax seal from the cataloguers' gallery to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the cataloguers' gallery, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 40, summer of year 30

Sunniva closed early, walked to the Archivist's cell, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Sunniva repaired the glass float at the sluice gates for Sable, who paid in 35 ink-weights and a long story about the rumour of a second well. Sunniva found a wax seal half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 41, spring of year 31

At the Archivist's cell, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the Archivist's cell. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the Archivist's cell. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 42, summer of year 31

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 9 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short.

Entry 43, spring of year 31

Caspian came by asking about the singing at the docks. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. Phaedra came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the Archivist's cell: 67 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short.

Entry 44, spring of year 31

Rumours about the missing shipment reached the Stacks of Ash. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the Stacks of Ash, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. Sunniva was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the Stacks of Ash to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Sunniva repaired the signal flag at the Archivist's cell for Zubair, who paid in 29 ink-weights and a long story about the new curfew.

Entry 45, spring of year 32

A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Dashiell came by asking about the missing shipment. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. Sunniva repaired the signal flag at the Archivist's cell for Zelda, who paid in 39 ink-weights and a long story about the quarantine.

Entry 46, spring of year 32

A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A stranger asked Sunniva for the password to the workshop. Sunniva laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the old tunnels reached the Archivist's cell. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 47, autumn of year 32

Sunniva closed early, walked to the Archivist's cell, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. Rumours about the old tunnels reached the Stacks of Ash. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the missing shipment. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right.

Entry 48, spring of year 32

Sunniva closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. Sunniva found a spool of wire half-buried near the Stacks of Ash and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Sunniva closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. Sunniva won 81 ink-weights from Cassius on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on grandmother's apple and onion hash.

Entry 49, spring of year 32

A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Sunniva found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Seraphine came by asking about the harvest count. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 9 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short.

Entry 50, summer of year 32

A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the Stacks of Ash; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 26 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short. Rumours about the harvest count reached the Stacks of Ash. Sunniva pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the new curfew. Sunniva read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Sunniva closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance.

Entry 51, autumn of year 32

At the sluice gates, Sunniva taught Kwame how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over the comet flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Sunniva found a ledger half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Sunniva found a grain scale half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 52, spring of year 32

Kenji visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Sunniva was hired to carry a pair of spectacles from the Stacks of Ash to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Sunniva suspects Kwame and is probably right.

Entry 53, spring of year 33

The weather turned. Sunniva moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about the comet. Sunniva closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Umbra followed at a distance. Sunniva spent the day counting stock at the cataloguers' gallery: 54 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. Nkechi came by asking about the tax on doors. Sunniva said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 54, autumn of year 33

The weather turned. Sunniva moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Umbra, and wrote three lines to Kenji about the harvest count. Sunniva found a sextant half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Sunniva and Cassius outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Sunniva was hired to carry a signal flag from the cataloguers' gallery to the Reading Well without opening it, and mostly succeeded.